

Line-Out port, which might be a boon to those with non-amplified speakers. It offers an ideal upgrade path for those stuck with onboard sound or an ISA-based card.

Specifications: 16-MIDI channel, 2.1 surround output, 16 bit CD-quality recording and playback, Mic-in, CD-Audio in, Line-out, Auxiliary in/rear out, MIDI/Joystick port

Price: Rs 1,100 **Contact:** Creative Technology Limited

Phone: 9820357713 **E-mail:** rajshekhar_bhattach@ctl.creative.com

Web site: asia.creative.com

Bose MediaMate Computer Speakers

Bose, a pioneer in the manufacturing of high-quality professional audio speakers, has come up with a solution for the perfect PC audio experience with its MediaMate



Specifications: Full-range stereo speakers, two RCA inputs, stereo headphone jack, 8.9 x 21.6 x 19.1 cm

Price: Rs 9,800 **Contact:** Bose Corporation India Pvt Ltd

Phone: 022-28324537/79 **E-mail:** bose_store@sify.com

Web site: www.bose.com

Artis S880

This all-back quad-channel speaker features a black wood finish and sports a very sophisticated workmanship. This speaker strikes a good balance between price and performance. S880 system stood out for its superior sound quality in gaming, as well as the movie tests where it provided powerful and

well-defined sound. If you already have a four-channel sound card, or intend to buy one, this is a good choice.

Artis S880 **B+**

Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Specifications: 10 Hz to 18 KHz frequency response, volume and bass control, 31 x 10 x 23.5 mm for subwoofer and 8.5 x 9.5 x 9.5mm for satellite

Price: Rs 4,000 **Contact:** Kunhar Peripherals Pvt Ltd

Phone: 022-56345758 **E-mail:** sales@kunhar.com

Web site: www.kunhar.com

Creative Vibra 128 **B+**

Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Creative Megaworks THX 5.1 550

Creative's latest offering, the Megaworks THX 5.1 550, will rock any music listener. These speakers are among the best you can buy for your personal computer. On the flip side, there are only analog inputs, no digital input. This is one hell of a sound system, simply superb! If you've got deep pockets, a large room and love

music, don't miss out on the best thing in the world of sound since—well, sound itself!

Creative Megaworks THX 5.1 550 **A+**

Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Specifications: 5.1 speakers, 150 W RMS subwoofer, 5 x 70 W RMS satellites, Frequency range 25 Hz to 20 KHz, 99 dB SNR

Accessories: Cable, desktop stands for satellite speakers, monitor stand for centre satellite speaker, wired remote control

Price: Rs 25,500 **Contact:** Creative Technology Ltd

Phone: 9820357713 **E-mail:** rajshekhar_bhattach@ctl.creative.com

Web site: www.creative.com

HANDHELD & LAPTOPS

ACi Emerald Pro

ACi's latest offering in India is the Emerald Pro, which boasts of a 2.4 GHz Pentium 4 processor. It may not sport the style or design of the big brands, but it's definitely a good choice for those who require superior performance for business

applications, at a very reasonable price.

ACi Emerald Pro **A-**

Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Specifications: Intel P4 2.4 GHz, 480 MB DDR SDRAM, 15.1-inch LCD Screen, 20 GB Hard Drive, 24X CD drive, built in Webcam, leather carry case, 2.8 kg weight

Price: Rs 94,000 **Contact:** Allied Computer International (Asia) Pvt. Ltd

Phone: 022-26733122 **E-mail:** sales@aci-asia.com

Web site: www.aci-asia.com

Toshiba Protégé 3500

The Toshiba Protégé 3500 is one of the first devices to feature the Tablet Edition of Windows XP Professional.



Targeted essentially at the business user on the move, the Protégé 3500 churns out a decent performance. Its price may not be a limiting factor for a mobile executive but for others it is still too high.

Toshiba Protégé 3500 **B+**

Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶